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AU PAIR & ELDERLY CARE GIVING ***A Comprehensive Course***

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MODULE ONE: AN INTRODUCTION TO ELDERLY CARE

After completing this module you'll be able to;

- State the roles of a caregiver.
- Mention the responsibilities of a caregiver.
- Define a caregiver
- Describe the legal responsibilities of a caregiver.
- Understand the ethical responsibilities of a caregiver.



UNDERTANDING CAREGIVING

What is Care Giving?

- Caregiving is providing care for the daily needs of someone that is unable to care for themselves. The care may include addressing the physical and emotional needs of someone that requires continuous support and attention. Most caregiving occurs in the individual homes, Old people's homes and hospitals.

What is a Care Giver?

- A caregiver is a person who tends to the needs or concerns of a person with short- or long-term limitations due to illness, injury or disability. help with activities of daily living as well as to provide companionship for their clients. They do not perform medical care. Instead, caregivers have a personal touch. They develop close ties with those in their care as they help with the day-to-day needs that a senior might not be able to do on their own any longer. Whether it's bathing, or grocery shopping, or even cooking their meals, a caregiver can help fill in the gap for seniors who otherwise would not be able to continue living on their own.

TYPES OF CARE GIVERS.

There are different types of caregivers when it comes to senior care. When it comes to finding adequate care for your later years, you'll find there are a lot of options. From caregivers to nursing homes and everything between, it can be daunting to determine which is best for you. Ultimately, the best way to start is determining the needs of you or your loved one when analyzing the types of caregivers available.

a) **Private-Duty Caregiver:**

Private-duty caregivers are hired through an agency. These caregivers are typically screened through the agency, bonded, and insured. Working through a caregiver agency, families can get a backup caregiver if their scheduled caregiver can't make a shift.

b) **Independent Caregivers:**

These caregivers are also known as private caregivers, but they should not be confused with private-duty caregivers. Independent caregivers do now work through an agency. While the cost can be cheaper, families paying for these caregivers take on the liability of letting someone in their home.

c) **Family Caregivers:**

Family caregivers are members of the family who choose to care for a loved one. These caregivers may be children, spouses, or other family members. They may work another job in addition to their responsibilities and usually don't receive compensation for their service.

d) **Informal Caregivers:**

Informal caregivers provide similar services to those of family caregivers. This difference is in most cases; these types of caregivers aren't related to the person receiving care. That said, these caregivers have some connection or relation to their clients. This makes it helpful for creating the companionship many seniors seek.

e) **Professional Caregivers:**

Professional caregivers are career caregivers, so their primary occupation is caregiving. These caregivers work with a care recipient either in their home or in a facility to ensure they receive

proper care. Professional caregivers work for agencies, so they are typically assigned when you hire the agency. They provide everything from homemaker services to medical care if necessary.

f) **Hospice Caregivers:**

Hospice caregivers are hired toward the end of a care recipient's life. In most cases, the care recipient has some type of terminal illness. These types of caregivers provide the standard caregiving duties but also focus on prioritizing comfort and quality of life when possible.

g) **Respite Caregivers:**

A respite caregiver provides care for a period of time to give a family caregiver a break. These caregivers can be private-duty or independent caregivers, but the role implies that they are not long-term caregivers.



TYPES OF CAREGIVING FACILITIES

1. **Virtual Caregiving:**

Sometimes, it's not possible for a caregiver to be in the care recipient's home either due to safety or health reasons; that's where virtual caregivers come in. By using a tablet or other type of screen, caregivers interact with their clients through Skype or another form of video call to ensure their health is monitored. This type of caregiving should be supplemental to in-home services. That said, it still helps in caregiving with medication reminders or health screenings. It's also helpful for companionship.

2. **Adult Day Care Centers:**

For seniors who don't do well in their home environment alone, there's adult daycare. Adult Daycare offers the opportunity for seniors to have stimulating social, cognitive, and physical activity outside of the home for a part of the day. Your loved one may be unsafe alone, can't perform daily activities, and is alone for most of the day. Adult day care may be a good option for addressing these concerns. These programs typically supplement an in-home caregiver, usually in situations where a family member, who is also the caregiver, has another job.

3. **Nursing Homes:**

If your loved one has a chronic condition or cannot return to their daily life after an injury or illness, a nursing home may be the best outlet for them to receive the short or long-term care they need. Nursing homes provide a variety of rehabilitative therapies, medical assistance, and higher levels of aid than what a typical caregiver provides. Some living in a nursing home may be bedridden, have a physical or mental disability, have Alzheimer's or Dementia, or need more medical attention.

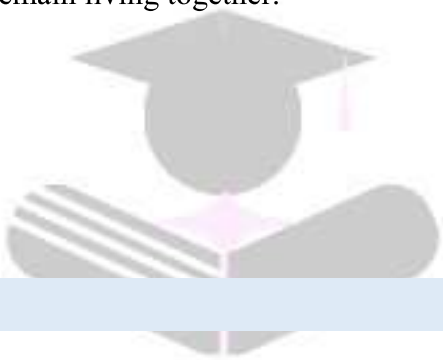
4. **Assisted Living Facilities:**

Assisted Living Facilities come in all shapes and sizes but are typically designed to provide a basic level of care and assistance to their residents. These facilities offer social activities, a community setting, and other services to enrich the lives of those living there. Outside of these services, care is provided periodically and as needed, like in the case of administering

medication. The assisted living staff provides care as needed and not constantly like in the case of a caregiver.

5. **Continuing Care Retirement Communities (CCRC):**

Continuing Care Retirement Communities are the ideal option for seniors who would like to move into a comfortable living arrangement where they can settle down for the rest of their lives. These communities provide a staged approach to ageing with independent living, assisted living, and frail care all available in the same community. This allows seniors to get the increasing level of care they need over time without having to leave their friends and familiar environment they've enjoyed through the years. It's also a great option for couples who have different levels of care needs but want to remain living together.



CAREGIVER QUALIFICATIONS

Every Preferred Care at Home caregiver possesses two key qualifications: a compassionate heart and home care experience. The first and most significant caregiver qualification is the compassionate heart. No training can create this uncompromising, required quality. It's simply part of who the caregiver is. This is a mandatory prerequisite for every one of our caregivers. Becoming a professional caregiver requires specific skills, passion, and a commitment to serving clients cheerfully even when you are having a bad day.

Preferred Care at Home's caregivers also have the following qualities:

- Unselfishness. They put others first.
- A loving heart. They show unconditional, loving kindness.
- A cheerful heart.
- Commitment and flexibility.